

MOHAMMAD KASHIF

SDET Lead / Technical Lead — Automation, DevOps, Project Delivery & Team Leadership | 15+ Years

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PROFILE

Hands-on SDET Lead and Technical Lead with 15+ years combining deep automation engineering with project delivery and people leadership. Codes, architects, and delivers — owns end-to-end quality across the full SDLC. Builds and scales automation frameworks (Playwright, Selenium, Cypress, Appium) and CI/CD pipelines. Leads and mentors engineering teams (8–15 engineers), coaches competence development, and drives hiring. Establishes Center of Excellence (CoE) practices — defines testing strategy, automation guidelines, quality gates, and reusable frameworks. Manages project scope, schedule, budget, and risk. Connects with business stakeholders, manages vendor relationships, and leads RFP/RFI technical responses. Designs solutions and frameworks for complex platforms. Security-aware — Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH). Cloud-native delivery on GCP and AWS (Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD). Shipped products to 300M+ users at IKEA, Truecaller, and LEGO. Line management experience.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Automation & SDET: Playwright, Selenium, Cypress, Appium. API testing (REST, GraphQL). E2E, integration, regression, performance. TDD/BDD. Framework design and architecture. CI/CD integration. AI-assisted test generation

Project & Delivery Management: Scope, schedule, budget, risk management. Roadmap & OKRs. Backlog prioritization. Multi-partner coordination. Resource allocation. Agile (Scrum/SAFe), Waterfall. Audit-ready reporting

Leadership & CoE: Line management (8–15 engineers). Coaching, mentoring, competence development. Hiring & talent retention. Center of Excellence — testing strategy, automation guidelines, quality gates, reusable frameworks. Knowledge sharing & evangelization

Stakeholder, Vendor & Business: Business stakeholder alignment. Vendor management & managed service relationships. RFP/RFI technical input & POC delivery. Solution design. Cross-functional collaboration (engineering, product, business)

DevOps & Cloud: GCP (Cloud Run, BigQuery, Cloud Functions), AWS. Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes. GitHub Actions, Jenkins. Infrastructure as Code. Grafana observability. Data pipelines

Security & Compliance: CEH (Certified Ethical Hacker). Security testing. Regulatory compliance awareness. Quality gate management. Six Sigma Green Belt. ISTQB. ITIL Foundation

Programming: Python, TypeScript, C#, Java, Node.js. REST APIs. SQL. Git. Jira, Confluence, TestRail, MS Project

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IKEA IT AB, Malmö — Team Lead (Acting) / SDET

Mar 2022 – Present | VCS Platform — Omni-Channel, 30+ Global Markets

- End-to-end ownership of IKEA's Visual Collaboration Solution (VCS) — scaled RCMP from 2K to 50K usage across 30+ markets, turning the RCMP sales business green. Full solution ownership: **automation**, DevOps, quality, and delivery.
- Line management — responsible for engineering team plus consultants. Coaching, competence development, continuous follow-up. Hiring and talent retention. Mentoring engineers on **automation** best practices, code quality, and career growth.
- CoE & testing strategy — established **automation** guidelines, quality gates, and reusable frameworks. Defined testing strategy and acceptance criteria. Owned roadmap, OKRs, and backlog prioritization for benefit realization.
- Business stakeholder & vendor management — bridged IKEA business **leadership** and SaaS platform vendor. Managed service relationship, aligned delivery with business KPIs. Cross-functional collaboration with POs, PMs, and stakeholders.
- **Automation** & DevOps — Playwright, API testing, CI/CD (GitHub Actions). Terraform, Docker on GCP. Data pipelines (BigQuery, Cloud Functions). Grafana observability. AI-assisted — 30% velocity improvement. Led Selenium-to-Playwright migration (3x faster execution, 50% CI pipeline reduction).
- **Budget** & resource management — planning, forecasting, follow-up. Capacity planning. Prioritization. Risk identification and mitigation. Audit-ready reporting.

Truecaller, Stockholm — Release & Automation Engineer

Sep 2021 – Feb 2022 | Communication Platform — 300M+ Users

- Project leadership at global scale — owned scope, schedule, risk, and release readiness for 300M+ users. Go/no-go decisions. Stakeholder interface. Release **automation** — built tools and workflows to streamline release processes. CI pipelines, build systems, deployment automation. AWS cloud infrastructure.
- Cross-functional coordination — backlog prioritization, supplier coordination, resource allocation. Feature flag management and data-driven rollouts across global markets. Onboarded engineers. **Agile** (Scrum/Kanban).

HCLTech — LEGO & IKEA Group, Denmark & Sweden — Technical Specialist / SDET Lead

2013 – 2021 | E-Commerce, Mobile & Enterprise — Multi-Partner Delivery

- LEGO & IKEA (2017–2021): Led test scope, timelines, risk, and delivery across iOS, Android, and web platforms. Multi-partner coordination. Designed and executed **automation** strategy across mobile and web. Built test automation for beta OS releases. Release readiness, quality gate decisions. Onshore-offshore team management.
- **SDET** Lead (2013–2017): Full SDLC ownership — requirements through production monitoring. Designed and scaled Selenium frameworks (C#, NUnit). CI execution. RFP/RFI technical input and POC delivery — built working automation POCs to demonstrate feasibility and win new business. Sprint and quality reporting for leadership visibility.

Banking & Enterprise — SDET / Consultant

2008 – 2013 | Finacle CBS, Core Banking — Regulated Environments

- Led testing workstreams for core banking systems (Finacle CBS, biometric authentication). Test **automation** — automated scripts from functional specifications. ETL automation with Pentaho. Data validation (SQL, UNIX). Regulatory compliance and banking security standards. Client interface and defect coordination.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Scaled IKEA RCMP from 2K to 50K usage across 30+ markets — end-to-end solution ownership, directly turning the RCMP sales business green. Recognized as Exceptional Performer.
- Led Selenium-to-**Playwright** migration — 3x faster test execution, 50% CI pipeline reduction, improved developer adoption across multiple teams.
- CoE & **automation** evangelization — established testing strategy, automation guidelines, quality gates, and reusable frameworks. Mentored engineers, drove competence development, and built high-performing teams.
- RFP/RFI & solution design — led technical input for RFP/RFI responses. Built working **automation** POCs to demonstrate feasibility and win new engagements.
- Business-**vendor** bridge — managed SaaS vendor relationship at IKEA, aligning vendor roadmap with IKEA's omni-channel growth strategy and business KPIs.

PERSONAL PROJECT

SimpleRx — AI-Powered Health Report Assistant (Google Play) | Co-Founder & Developer, DQODIFY Pvt. Ltd.
AI app translating medical reports into plain language (Hindi & English). End-to-end ownership: product vision, AI/LLM integration, mobile development, Play Store deployment. Privacy-first — encrypted storage, user-controlled data deletion.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Education	Certifications
B.Tech in Information Technology PG Diploma in Operations Management	ISTQB Certified Tester Foundation Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH) Google Cloud – Associate Cloud Engineer AWS Cloud Practitioner Six Sigma Green Belt ITIL Foundation UiPath RPA Certified